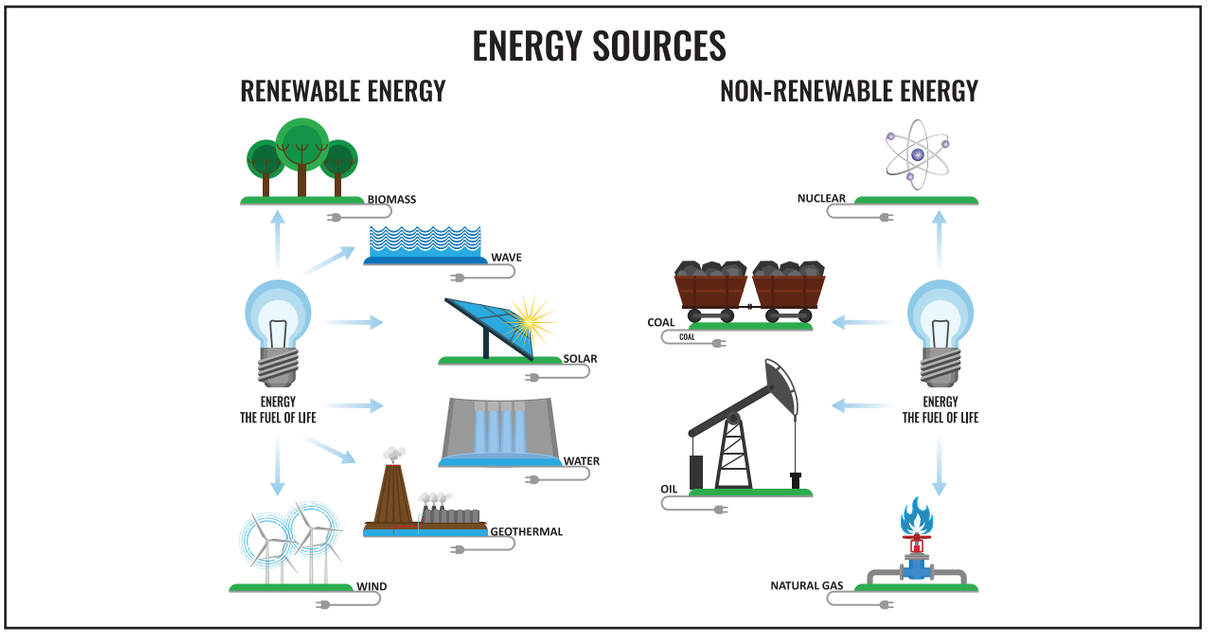


(i) **Peat** is the first stage of transformation of wood into coal and it has only 30% to 35% of carbon.

(ii) **Lignite or Brown coal** is the inferior quality and contains 35%-45% carbon

(iii) **Bituminous or coking coal** is the second best variety of coal and contains 70%-90% of carbon. It is the most widely spread and most widely used variety of coal. It is the most popular coal in commercial use.

(iv) **Anthracite** is the best quality coal, which contains more than 95% of carbon. It is very hard but emits very less smoke and leaves very less ash. However its deposits are limited.

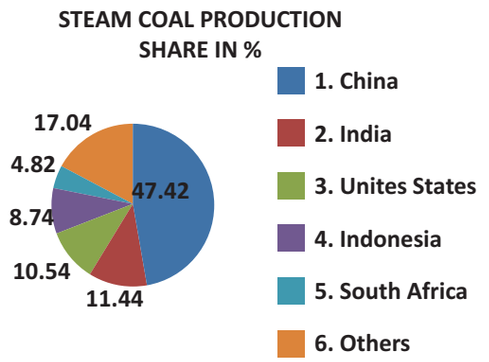
Production and world distribution of Coal

Coal reserves are found in more than 70 countries of the world but the major coal reserves occur in the USA, Russia, China and South Africa. China is the largest producer of steam coal in the world followed by India. The other leading producers of steam coal are USA, Indonesia, and South Africa etc.

Steam coal – It is used for producing steam and it has high sulphur content

Steam Coal

Rank	Country	Production (Metric Ton)	Share in%
1	China	2,491,793,000	47.42
2	India	601,131,000	11.44
3	United States	553,936,000	10.54
4	Indonesia	459,469,000	8.74
5	South Africa	253,452,000	4.82
	Others		17.04



HOTS

Why is hydrogen used as fuel in rockets?

China was the largest producer of coking coal in the world in 2016 followed by Australia. The other leading producers of coking coal are Russia, India and USA.

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